CLINICAL PRE-CERTIFICATION ORDER: MRI LUMBAR SPINE (POLICY RESOLVED)

1. PATIENT & ENCOUNTER INFORMATION

Patient Name: John Doe Date of Birth: 04/12/1978 (Age: 48, Male)
Member ID: MEM-88219 Date of Service: 2026-02-26
Health Plan: Commercial Choice Plus Payer: Centene / Evolent Commercial

2. ORDERING PHYSICIAN & PRACTICE

Attending Physician: Dr. Yu, MD Specialty: Spine & Orthopedics
Facility / Practice: Metro Orthopedic Spine Institute, Outpatient Clinic
State Medical License: Active Verified NPI: 1982736450

3. ORDERED PROCEDURE & DIAGNOSTIC CODING

Requested Procedure: MRI Lumbar Spine without contrast
Procedure Code: CPT 72148 Clinical Domain: Advanced Imaging
Primary Diagnosis: Muscle spasm of back with radiculopathy (ICD-10 M62.838)

4. CLINICAL HISTORY & SYMPTOMS

Patient presents with severe lower back pain radiating down the right lower extremity in the L5 dermatome for 8 consecutive weeks. Symptoms have caused functional limitations in daily ambulation and occupational duties. Physical examination demonstrates positive straight leg raise test on the right at 40 degrees and diminished sensory perception along the right lateral calf and dorsal foot.

5. CONSERVATIVE THERAPY & OBJECTIVE FINDINGS

Patient has completed 6 weeks of structured physical therapy (2 sessions per week) with certified physical therapist. Concurrent oral NSAID therapy (Meloxicam 15 mg daily) and activity modification were maintained without functional relief. Physical therapy progress notes and compliance logs have been reviewed and documented in medical chart.

6. RED FLAGS & CONTRAINDICATIONS ASSESSMENT

Negative for acute cauda equina syndrome. No evidence of bowel or bladder incontinence.
No progressive focal motor weakness or saddle anesthesia.

7. PHYSICIAN CERTIFICATION & CLINICAL ORDER

I certify that clinical indication criteria for MRI Lumbar Spine without contrast (CPT 72148) are met under 2026 Guidelines.
Dr. Yu, MD - Attending Spine & Orthopedic Specialist